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SUPERSEDING
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February 10, 1958

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

FILE BACKER, PAPER

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 This specification covers one type of a letter-size paper file backer, equipped with a prong type metal paper fastener.

2. APPLICABLE SPECIFICATIONS, STANDARDS, AND OTHER PUBLICATIONS

2.1 The following specifications and standards of the issue in effect on the date of invitation for bids, form a part of this specification:

Federal Specifications:

UU-P-31—Paper, General Specification and Methods of Testing.

PPP-B-636—Boxes, Fiber.

PPP-B-676—Boxes, Set-up, Paperboard.

PPP-T-60 — Tape; Pressure Sensitive Adhesive, Waterproof—for Packaging and Sealing.

PPP-T-76 — Tape; Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive, Paper, Water Resistant.

PPP-T-97 — Tape; Pressure-Sensitive Adhesive, Filament Reinforced.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 102—Preservation, Packaging, and Packing Levels.

Fed. Std. No. 123—Marking for Domestic Shipment (Civilian Agencies).

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U. S. Government Printing Office, Washington 25, D. C.

(Single copies of this specification and other product specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, Mo., Dallas, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, Seattle, and Washington, D. C.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Specifications:

MIL-L-10547 — Liners, Case, Waterproof.

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 — Sampling Procedures and Tables for Inspection by Attributes.

MIL-STD-129 — Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by the contractor in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other publications. — The following document forms a part of this specification.

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Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids shall apply.

Uniform Freight Classification Rules.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Freight Classification Committee, 202 Chicago Union Station, Chicago 6, Ill.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material. — The material of the file backer, shall be 100 percent sulfate pulp (natural color), conforming to the physical properties of paragraph 3.2.

3.2 Physical properties.

3.2.1 *Basis weight.* — The weight of the material shall be 147 pounds, based on 500 sheets, 24 inches by 36 inches. A tolerance of plus or minus 5 percent shall be permitted.

3.2.2 *Thickness.*—The thickness of the material shall be 0.011 inches. A tolerance of plus or minus 0.0005 inches shall be permitted.

3.2.3 *Tearing strength.* — The minimum tearing resistance, total of both directions, shall be 620 grams.

3.3 Dimensions.—The file backer shall be 8½ by 11 inches. A tolerance of plus or minus 1/32 inch shall be permitted. Edges shall be shear cut and square within the dimensional tolerance.

3.4 Grain.—The grain shall run parallel with the largest dimension.

3.5 Paper fastener.—The paper fastener shall be a 2¾-inch prong type metal paper fastener. It shall be made of metal 0.012 inch thick, plus or minus 0.002 inch, coated with lacquer or baked enamel or tinned. Prongs shall be attached to, or a continuation of, each end of the base. The prongs shall have a width of not less than 3/16 inch or more than 7/32 inch. The prong length shall be 1½ inches, plus or minus 1/16 inch. The fastener shall not fracture when subjected to the bend test described in 4.5.2.

3.6 Mounting of paper fastener. — The paper fastener shall be permanently affixed and centered 1 1/16 inch, plus or minus 1/16 inch, from the top of the file backer, on the 8½ inch side.

3.7 Workmanship.—The file backer shall be free from defects, which may affect serviceability or appearance, and the finish shall be smooth and uniform. The fastener shall be free from burrs and sharp or rough edges or corners which may injure the user or damage the papers filed.

4. SAMPLING, INSPECTION, AND TEST PROCEDURES

4.1 Unless otherwise specified herein the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements prior to submission for Government inspection and acceptance. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any other commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. Inspection records of the examinations and tests shall be kept complete and available to the Government as specified in the contract or order.

4.2 Lot.—A lot shall consist of all the file backers offered for delivery at one time.

4.3 Sampling.

4.3.1 *Shipping containers.* — A random sample of packed and marked shipping containers of file backers shall be selected from each lot in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–105. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 4.0 percent defective.

4.3.2 *File backers.*—A random sample of file backers shall be selected in accordance with the Appendix to Military Standard MIL–STD–105, inspection level L6. The acceptable quality level (AQL) shall be 2.5 percent defective.

4.3.3 *For test.*—A random sample of file backers shall be selected from the samples selected for examination (4.3.2). Not less than 10 file backers shall be selected for test.

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4.4 **Examination.**

4.4.1 *Shipping containers.*—Each sample container selected in accordance with 4.3.1 shall be examined for the defects listed in table I.

4.4.2 *File backers.* — Each sample file backer selected in accordance with 4.3.2 shall be examined for the defects listed in table I.

TABLE I.—*Classification of Defects*

(The Government reserves the right to classify as a defect, any departure from this specification not specifically listed in table I.)

(AQL 4.0)	
Shipping containers	Wrong type.
	Wrong class.
	Holes in container walls.
	Inadequate closure (flaps do not meet or cannot be lifted without fiber failure).
	Marking incorrect.
	Marking missing.
	Marking illegible.
Packaging	Not as specified.
(AQL 2.5)	
Dimensions and trim	Dimensions not as specified or within tolerance.
	Edges not shear cut or square within tolerance.
Grain	Grain not parallel with largest dimension.
File backers	Not clean; edges torn; corners split or broken. Welted, curled or wavy. Lumpy.
Paper fastener	Not permanently fixed to backer and centered. Not dimensions specified. Not coated. Not free of burrs, rough edges or corner.
Count (sample average)	Packages average fewer file backers than specified per package.

4.5 **Tests.**

4.5.1 *Material test.*—Samples taken as described in 4.3.3 shall be tested in accordance with the following test methods described in Federal Specification UU–P–31. Failure to meet the requirements of the tests shall be considered as cause for rejection of the lot.

Test	Method
Atmospheric conditions	102
Basis weight	110
Machine direction (grain)	140
Tearing resistance	170
Thickness	173
Fiber identification and quantitative determination	300

4.5.2 *Bend test.*—Each sample fastener selected in accordance with 4.3.3 shall be subjected to repeated cold bend test by; first, inserting the prongs through the perforations of one sheet of paper and bending prongs down to the base (prong position when fastener is secured) and back to original open position (through not less than 90 degrees arc) a minimum of 20 times; second, inserting the prongs through the perforations of sheets of paper having a total thickness of not less than one-half the capacity of the fastener; the fastener shall be completely assembled and each prong bent back to its original position and the cycle repeated 50 times. The prongs shall show no evidence of fracture at any point when tests are completed. Fracture of any prong will be considered as failure to meet the requirements of the specification.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

For civil agency procurement the definitions and applications of the levels of packaging and packing shall be in accordance with Federal Standard No. 102.

5.1 **Packaging.**—File backers shall be packaged level A or C, as specified (see 6.2).

5.1.1 *Level A.*—File backers shall be packaged 100 each in paperboard set-up boxes conforming to Federal Specification PPP–B–676.

5.1.2 *Level C.*—File backers shall be packaged in accordance with the manufacturer's commercial practice.

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5.2 **Packing.**—File backers, packaged level A or C, shall be packed level A, B or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 *Level A.*—Five boxes of file backers shall be packed in corrugated or solid fiber boxes conforming to Federal Specification PPP–B–636, type I or II, class 2. Fiberboard boxes shall be fitted with waterproof case liners conforming to Military Specification MIL–L–10547, class 2 and sealed in accordance with the appendix thereto. Box closures shall be in accordance with the box specification. In lieu of a caseliner, 2 inch wide pressure-sensitive tape conforming to Federal Specification PPP–T–60 (type III, class 1), or PPP–T–76 may be applied over all corners and joints, including manufacturer's joint, of the boxes. In lieu of steel strapping, boxes may be reinforced with pressure-sensitive filament tape conforming to type IV of Federal Specification PPP–T–97, applied in accordance with the appendix thereto.

5.2.2 *Level B.*—Five boxes of file backers shall be packed in corrugated or solid fiberboard boxes conforming to Federal Specification PPP–B–636, class 1, style RSC. Box closures shall be in accordance with the box specification.

5.2.3 *Level C.*—File backers shall be packed in containers of the type, size and kind commonly used for the purpose, in a manner that will insure acceptance by common carrier and safe delivery at destination. Shipping containers shall comply with the Uniform Freight Classification Rules, or regulations of other carriers as applicable to the mode of transportation.

5.3 **Marking.**

5.3.1 *Civil agencies.*—In addition to any special marking specified in the contract or order, unit packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Federal Standard No. 123.

5.3.2 *Military agencies.* — In addition to any special marking required by the contract or order, interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with Military Standard MIL–STD–129.

6. NOTES

6.1 **Intended use.** — File backers are intended for filing papers, when the protection of a file folder is not required.

6.2 **Ordering data.** — Procurement documents should specify the following:

(*a*) Title, number, and date of this specification.

(*b*) Both the level of packaging and the level of packing required (see 5.1 and 5.2).

6.3 Items procured under this specification for military use are to be limited to the variety shown on the applicable military standards. Personnel of the military departments are requested to refer to these documents for guidance.

Notice. — When Government drawings, specifications, or other data are used for any purpose other than in connection with a definitely related Government procurement operation, the United States Government thereby incurs no responsibility nor any obligation whatsoever; and the fact that the Government may have formulated, furnished, or in any way supplied the said drawings, specifications, or other data, is not to be regarded by implication or otherwise as in any manner licensing the holder or any other person or corporation, or conveying any rights or permission to manufacture, use, or sell any patented invention that may in any way be related thereto.

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Navy—Bureau of Supplies and Accounts
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Copies of this specification may be purchased for 5 cents each.

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